

The Glorious Essence of Wisdom, King of Kings among the Great Tantras of the Yoginī

Śrī-Jñānagarbha-nāma-yoginī-mahātantra-rāja-yati-rāja · Toh 421 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་ཡེ་ཤེས་སྒྲི་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་རྒྱ་འབརྩེ་མ་ཆེ་མའི་རྒྱ་ཀྱི་ལྷ་པོའི་རྒྱ་པོ་

The Glorious Essence of Wisdom, known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Jñānagarbha Yoginī Mahātantra Rāja Yati Rāja and in Tibetan as Dpal Ye shes snying po, is a yoginī tantra belonging to the highest class of esoteric Buddhist literature. It takes the form of a dialogue set at the summit of Mount Meru, where the Buddha, surrounded by vast assemblies of ḍākas and ḍākinīs, reveals tantric teachings in the context of sacred union with the goddess Lekgyé Wangmo. As its full title proclaims, it presents itself as the King of Kings among the Great Tantras of the Yoginī, indicating its exalted status within the Vajrayāna textual tradition. It is catalogued as Toh 421 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the tantric scriptures.

In the language of India: Śrī-Jñānagarbha-nāma-yoginī-mahātantra-rāja-yati-rāja. In the Tibetan language: The Glorious Essence of Wisdom, King of Kings among the Great Tantras of the Yoginī.

Homage to the glorious Vajrasattva.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at the summit of Mount Meru, in the great pleasure grove of Bhagula, encircled on all sides by seventy-two billion ḍākas and ḍākinīs. There, while the Blessed One was engaged in union with the goddess Lekgyé Wangmo, the hairs of the Venerable One's body stood on end. At that moment, the Blessed One Lekgyé Wangmo rose from the union, circumambulated three times, bowed her head to his feet in prostration, and spoke these words: "Alas, Blessed One, why have the hairs of your body stood on end?"

The Blessed One declared: "O Blessed Lady, what is the matter? The reason my body hair has stood on end is a great secret."

The Blessed Lady said: "Though it is a great secret, Sovereign of the Supreme, please speak."

The Blessed One declared: "I experienced the bliss of Lekgyé, and the network of seventy-two billion root-channels of my own being that generates the joy of

those who dwell above and below trembled and stirred, and from that the sign arose. From the arising of the sign, the king of bindus was released. From the release of the king of bindus, there came a gathering toward those who dwell above and below and who generate joy."

The Blessed Lady said: "How is it that there was a gathering toward those who dwell above and below and who generate joy?"

The Blessed One declared: "Why do you not understand the nature of that gathering toward those who dwell above and below and who generate joy?"

The Blessed Lady said: "Blessed One, though it is indeed as you say, it is because I do not understand that I have asked the Blessed One."

The Blessed One declared: "Though this is something to be known through one's own direct experience, I shall nonetheless explain it so that you are satisfied. By the mere trembling and stirring of the network of seventy-two billion root-channels of one's own being — the very channels that give rise to the joy of liberation — the sign arose. From the arising of the sign, the king of bindus was released. From the release of the king of bindus, there came a gathering toward those who dwell above and below and who generate joy."

Upon hearing this, the Blessed Lady bowed her head to the feet of the Blessed One in prostration, embraced him tightly, delighted him with the nectar-drink of her lips, and then asked again:

"O Blessed One, if there is a gathering at the moment of the joy of liberation, then what is the moment when there is no such union?"

The Blessed One declared:

"O excellent one who asks with perfect joy,
That which buddhas rarely find —
At the moment of liberation, there is no union;
That is not the joy of liberation."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "O Blessed One, what is the distinction between the joy of liberation and liberation itself?"

The Blessed One declared: "O joyful one, why do you speak thus? Between the joy of liberation and liberation, there is indeed a great distinction — let it be stated. The joy of liberation is the bindu that remains, free from transference and the like. Liberation is that which is free from joy — a bindu that moves and dissolves. The joy of liberation, being a bindu that remains and is free from

transference and the like, is of the nature of direct personal experience."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "What is the distinction between the joy of liberation, characterized as direct personal experience, and innate joy?"

The Blessed One declared: "Innate joy is neither a thing nor a non-thing."

It is not secret, not gnosis, not something arisen from gnosis. It is not existence, not nirvāṇa, not a drop, not a bindu, not a mode, not even a mere mode. It is not supreme, not another's supreme. It is not arising, not ceasing. It is not form, not sound, not smell, not taste, not touch, not syllable. It is not a support, not that which relies on a support, not an element, not wisdom, not skillful means, not dissolution, not enjoyment, not empowerment, not emanation, not a phenomenon, not enjoyment, not body, not speech, not mind. It is free from all aspects, inexhaustible, stainless, unborn, unceasing — ever arising.

The Blessed Lady spoke: "From where is such innate joy obtained?"

The Blessed One declared: "It is obtained from the direct experience of joy free from joy, and not, in the same way, from meditative concentration and the like."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "Is innate joy the cause or the result of the direct experience of joy free from joy?"

The Blessed One declared: "It is the cause of innate joy, not the result."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "If innate joy arises spontaneously and self-perfected, what need is there for a thing that is a cause? Since it has no intrinsic nature, it is like smoke from fire."

The Blessed One declared: "To say so is not a valid cognition. If there is no fire to begin with, from where would smoke arise there? Innate joy is of just such a nature."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "If it is so, then from innate joy, joy free from joy is both a cause and a result. Yet here cause is distinguished into two, and result likewise into two: the cause of illumination and the cause of arising. And so too with the result."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "O Blessed One, please explain what the cause of illumination is like and what the cause of arising is like."

The Blessed One declared: "The cause of illumination is the joy free from joy — like a lamp. The cause of arising is supreme joy arising from joy — like a sprout

from a seed. Joy free from joy is not the cause of arising, because it is unlike the others. It arises from what is unlike other joys."

This concludes the first chapter, on the meaning of innate joy, from the glorious Jñānasāra, entitled "The Meaning of Innate Joy."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "In order to obtain that which teaches the meaning of mahāmudrā from the king of tantras of the bindu of the glorious Mahāmudrā, may the Blessed One please teach me the method for obtaining it."

The Blessed One declared: "That which you have asked of me — listen, O Goddess, I shall explain it fully. Mahāmudrā (Skt. mahāmudrā) is here distinguished into four: the karma mudrā, the samaya mudrā, the gnosis mudrā, and the Dharma mudrā. The karma mudrā is of the nature of luminous appearance, endowed with the stage of joy. The samaya mudrā is of the nature of spreading luminous appearance, endowed with the stage of the sense base. The gnosis mudrā is of the nature of luminous appearance attained, endowed with the stage of the element. The Dharma mudrā is of the nature of luminosity. And the Great Seal, mahāmudrā itself, is not to be found anywhere other than luminosity."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "Blessed One, what is that which is called luminosity? Where does it dwell?"

The Blessed One declared:

"Luminosity is the essential nature of the bindu (Skt. bindu) dwelling in the midst of space, and from it the Great Seal, mahāmudrā, is to be found."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "Blessed One, how exactly is luminosity to be found?"

The Blessed One declared: "Through the karma mudrā, the samaya mudrā, the gnosis mudrā, and the Dharma mudrā."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "And the mudrās themselves — from what are they to be found?"

The Blessed One declared: "Relying on the outer mudrā of empowerment, the inner mudrās are found."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "Where do those outer and inner mudrās abide? What are their characteristics? What is their intrinsic nature? And what are the empowerments pertaining to them?"

The Blessed One declared: "Here there are four empowerments: the master empowerment, the secret empowerment, the wisdom-gnosis empowerment,

and the fourth, which is thus and likewise. The master empowerment consists in touching the breasts and thighs of a young woman endowed with the stage of joy, while one holds the vajra and bell together in union. The secret empowerment arises from fully filling the inner vessel of a young woman endowed with the stage of the sense base. The wisdom-gnosis empowerment consists in experiencing gnosis at the moment when the melting substance is transferred through the great skillful means of mutual churning and being churned, in union with a young woman endowed with the stage of the element. The fourth, which is thus and likewise, stabilizes that very wisdom-gnosis; and for that reason it is taught as 'thus and likewise.' Through the mere act of stabilization, the four mudrās are brought into union within the sixty-four petals. These, moreover, are characterized by their nature as entering, abiding, moving, and supporting. Entering is the fierce lady, caṇḍālī (Skt. caṇḍālī). Abiding is the absence of conceptual elaboration by intrinsic nature. Moving is the root of the bird-faced one. Supporting by nature is the root of the rope-lady. Ultimately, mahāmudrā alone is singular; yet by virtue of the nature of karmic action it is divided into four."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "Blessed One, what are the distinctions of karmic nature among these?"

The Blessed One declared: "Pacifying, enriching, magnetizing, and wrathful — these are the distinctions of karmic action, and they are attained through the Great Seal, mahāmudrā."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "Blessed One, what are the names and practices of pacifying, enriching, magnetizing, and wrathful?"

The Blessed One declared: "Pacifying is through laughter. Enriching is through gazing. Magnetizing is through embracing with the hands. Wrathful is through bringing two into union with two. Their practices are carried out through the conduct of the holy life of Brahmā (Skt. brahmacarya), the conduct of great observance, the conduct of the observance without garments, and the conduct of self-mastery."

This concludes the second chapter of the glorious Jñānasāra, entitled "The Great Seal, Mahāmudrā, and the Meaning of Empowerment."

The Blessed Lady spoke: "Blessed One, what form do the maṇḍalas take at the time of empowerment, and how should the master proceed?"

The Blessed One declared: "At the time of the master empowerment, the maṇḍala is one of colored sand and so forth. For the secret empowerment, the maṇḍala offered to the guru consists of flowers, including those that arise spontaneously. At the time of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment, the fourfold union endowed with the awakening mind, bodhicitta, serves as the maṇḍala. At the time of the fourth, nothing other than bodhicitta itself serves as the maṇḍala. As for the master: the empowerment is conferred by a master who is adorned with all the marks, who knows all the tantras, who is skilled in conferring empowerments, who is endowed with compassion, who is devoted to vast scope, who is proficient in mantra and other such matters, who is skilled in applying them, and who is a master who has attained spiritual accomplishment.

One who has received permission from a master who has attained spiritual accomplishment, or who has oneself attained spiritual accomplishment, is qualified to perform the maṇḍala, the sequence of conferring empowerment, the sādhana, and related activities. Those who are mere logicians and the like are not.

The Blessed Lady (the goddess consort) asked in verse:

O Blessed One, what are the characteristics
Of the maṇḍala for the master's empowerment?
What is the measure of the maṇḍala?
Who is its chief lord and master?
By what essential nature is the disciple taken hold of?
What manner of person is the action master?
What are the offerings to be made?
And what is the proper offering to the master?

The Blessed One declared in verse:

Whatever you have asked of me,
O goddess, listen — I shall explain it.
It accords with the aspiration of the disciple endowed with marks,
Or else with whatever seems fitting to the maṇḍala master.

In terms of size, the maṇḍala is to be made three finger-breadths beyond the thumb, measuring half a cubit and one span. This is, for the time being, the conventional symbolic maṇḍala, and it is to be performed according to the sequential procedure of the Yoginī tantras, with all its components complete. In its center, a solar disk is drawn. Upon that is placed the visva-vajra (the

cross-shaped vajra of many kinds): within the navel of the visva-vajra is a HŪṂ syllable, and on the outside it is adorned with a variegated lotus of eight petals, ornamentally encircled by a vajra garland. On the eastern petal is a white wheel; on the south, a yellow jewel; on the west, a red lotus; on the north, a green sword. At the fire corner is a jewel tree; at the water corner, a pomegranate; at the wind corner, a victory banner; and at the corner of Īśāna (the northeast), a skull-cup. At the eastern gate is a vajra-hook; at the south, a vajra-lasso; at the west, vajra-chains; and at the north, a vajra-bell. At the corners are festoons of flowers, incense sticks, lamps, and perfumed conch-shells as offerings. On the outside of all this is a vajra garland.

From the HŪṂ syllable within the navel of the visva-vajra, fully transformed, arises the great Vajradhara: with three faces, three eyes, and four arms; abiding in the royal posture; embraced by his own luminous wisdom-consort; blue in colour as the sky; adorned with all ornaments; possessed of the sixteen years of age; blazing with the light of ten million suns; crowned with a diadem of matted locks; the lord who holds the vajra, bell, a small drum, a skull-cup, and a khaṭvāṅga. In the context of the conventional symbolic maṇḍala, at the center a vajra and bell are used.

Thereupon, the disciple having been prepared, bathed with various medicinal substances, the master takes hold of the disciple by means of the essential nature of Vairocana. The action master is one skilled in all treatises, free from miserliness, and who has attained some degree of marks. The offering assistants there must be highly skilled, free from attachment and the like, possessed of marks, and having received the three empowerments.

At the time of conferring empowerment upon the master, or at the time of hearing the tantra, one must offer, to whatever extent one is able, one's most dearly beloved wife, one's daughters, and also gold, pearls, jewels, elephants, horses, fields, male servants, female servants, many garments, and the like. One who possesses wealth and the like yet does not make such offerings will be reborn in hell for a thousand aeons. Even one who has no material resources must offer their own body and serve as a servant. By doing so, one will attain buddhahood itself, or Vajradhara itself, in this very lifetime.

The goddess asked: Does one become a buddha or Vajradhara merely through generosity and such things?

The Blessed One declared: Goddess, one does not become a buddha or Vajradhara through generosity and such things alone. Nevertheless, through

making offerings to the guru, a great accumulation of merit is born. From having accumulated a great accumulation of merit, the mass of sins is exhausted. Then one obtains a true meeting with the supreme guru, who is the nature of all buddhas, and with one's own deity's body. Through that meeting, one receives genuine pith instructions. From receiving those pith instructions, one comes to be endowed with great diligence. Through that, one will attain buddhahood itself, or Vajradhara, in this very lifetime.

This was the third chapter, called "Empowerment and the Meaning of the Maṇḍala," from the Glorious Wisdom-Essence.

The Blessed One asked: What is your maṇḍala like? Great Lord, please declare it.

The Blessed One declared:

Listen now, O goddess, as I clearly describe
the virtue of my maṇḍala.

It is square with four gates,
adorned with four archways,
ornamented with lattices, garlands, hanging clusters,
and with sense-pleasures, precious jewels, and the like.
In its center, none other than myself,
fair of face, together with you.

With four faces and four arms,
three eyes, of dark blue lotus color,
bearing the six mudrās (ritual seals),
adorned with varied bone ornaments,
of the nature of supreme peace,
upon a variegated lotus,
I press upon the fearsome Lord of Time with my foot,
and remain in the royal seated posture.

I hold vajra, bell, small drum,
skull-cup, and khaṭvāṅga staff.

My other faces are yellow, red, and green.

You, O goddess, are of my own hue,
three-faced with three eyes,
your two hands holding a curved knife and a skull-bowl,
adorned with various ornaments.

The Blessed One asked: In the wheel of this maṇḍala, who are the retinue members, and how many are there?

The Blessed One declared:

That which you have asked me, goddess, hear now as I explain.

In the four directions of the maṇḍala are the great heroes,
embraced by wisdom-consorts in their arms.

At the corners are four vajra goddesses,
and at the gates are four wrathful goddesses.

The Blessed One asked: What is the generation rite for those figures? What are their colors, mudrās, postures, and so forth?

The Blessed One declared: From the sign of bliss arising in the great union of the method of union and merging, there is the great hero called Brahmā, with four arms, three faces, three eyes, of golden color, dwelling in the solar maṇḍala in the royal seated posture, crowned with a crown of matted locks, embraced by a wisdom-consort, holding the five mudrās, adorned with various ornaments, bearing vajra, bell, small drum, skull-cup, and khaṭvāṅga staff. He is in the eastern petal.

From the supreme sign of bliss in the method of union and merging, the great hero called Viṣṇu, of emerald color, otherwise the same as Brahmā, is in the north.

From the sign of bliss free from joy in the method of union and merging, the great hero called the Fierce One, of black color, like Viṣṇu, is in the west.

From the sign of innate bliss in the method of union and merging, the great hero called Īśvara, of white color, like Viṣṇu, is in the south.

At the corners of the lotus, upon vases filled with fragrant water, are four skull-cups filled with the five nectars.

Again, from the eight flavors of the method of union and merging, at the fire corner is a great heroic goddess of white color. At the water corner is one who overpowers all others, of lapis lazuli color.

At the wind corner is the goddess Duṣmaṇā, of dark blue sky-color. At the corner of the lord of power is Gaurī, of yellow color. All of them are in the full bloom of youth, with a single face, three eyes, and four arms, seated in the royal posture upon a solar disc, adorned with the five mudrās, clothed in the garments of the directions, and holding a curved blade, a skull-cup, a khaṭvāṅga staff, and a small drum.

At the eastern gate is Vajra Caṇḍālī, of great black color. At the northern gate is Vajra Bhairavī, of yellow color. At the western gate is Vajra Ghaṇṭā, of great red color. At the southern gate is Vajra Carcikā, of green color. Each has four arms, a single face, and three eyes, with the left leg extended, unclothed, and dwelling respectively upon a garuḍa, a lion, a tiger, and a water buffalo. They are adorned with the five mudrās, holding a hanging garland of great skulls, terrifying with fangs bared and tongue curling, with blazing hair on end, roaring with a great thunderous sound, and holding a sword, a trident, a skull-cup, and a khaṭvāṅga staff, embracing their own radiance as their consort.

The Blessed Lady asked: O Blessed One, what are the limb-goddesses of the wisdom consort (prajñā) of each of the great heroes?

The Blessed One declared: The limb-goddesses of the great heroes each match the color of their respective hero, yet like yourself, each has a single face.

Such a maṇḍala king
Is rare to find in the tantras of yoga.
It accomplishes all joys
And destroys all evil.

The Blessed Lady asked:

What is the seed syllable for generating you and myself,
And what is the essence?
What is the near-essence?
And what are the mantras of the retinue?

The Blessed One declared:

You have asked me this.
Listen, O goddess — I shall explain.
The seventh of the consonant group,
Combined with the fifth of the vowel letters,
Adorned with the bindu — O great goddess —
Is your supreme seed syllable, most excellent.

The eighth of the consonant group,
Combined with the sixth of the vowel letters,
Its head adorned with the bindu —
Is my supreme seed syllable, most excellent.

These two seeds, both supreme,
Bring all under their sway.
They dwell in the heart of every embodied being,
Effecting both birth and withdrawal.

The sixth, eighth, fourth,
Twelfth, tenth, and twenty-second —
With om̐ at the beginning and hūṃ phaṭ at the end:
This is the utterly supreme essence of myself.

The twentieth, twelfth, the space,
The first, the sixteenth, and the twenty-second —
With the sovereign Brahmā, hūṃ phaṭ at the end:
This is the supreme and joyful essence of yourself.

With om̐ at the beginning, hūṃ phaṭ at the end,
And in the middle the name expanded:
This is the armor-mantra of the entire assembly,
To be offered at the time of offering.

Om̐ sarva māra vimardana mahāpārīrāja hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ.

O fortunate goddess, this is
Your fierce near-essence, great and powerful:

Om̐ haṃ haṃ haṃ haṃ haṃ haṃ. Kele kele sarva doṣa prabhañjaka hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ.

The face of the lotus — this is
My near-essence of great radiance.

The Blessed Lady asked: What is the power and potency of these mantras?

The Blessed One declared: By the mere accomplishment of recitation, one brings all three realms under one's sway. If a yogin recites one hundred thousand times with the wrathful gaze, he slays with that hundred thousand recitations even one such as the lord of the asuras. If recited in a peaceful mode, it eliminates countless diseases, mental afflictions, poverty, leprosy, and blindness. The eight minor siddhis are accomplished in an instant.

Furthermore, it follows along with many kinds of karma. Having thus declared these words, the Blessed One fell silent. Then the Blessed Lady Supriyā, Queen of Delight, rose from her seat, bowed her head in reverence, and, together with the entire retinue, circumambulated three times. Each by their own

miraculous power they made offerings, and proclaimed to the supremely lordly Blessed One: "Excellent! Excellent!" Then they abided in the union of non-duality.

At that very moment, from the sky there fell before the feet of the Blessed One a great rain of flowers of many varieties and a great rain of precious jewels of many kinds.

The Blessed One then mounted upon those flowers and jewels and, together with the retinue, vanished from sight.

This concludes the fourth chapter of the Glorious Essence of Wisdom, entitled "The Arising of the Secret Maṇḍala."

The Glorious Essence of Wisdom, the Tantra of the Great Yoginī —

Translator's Notes

- The term rendered throughout as "bindu" (Tibetan བུ་བྱ་མཆོག་) refers to the subtle-body drop, a key technical term in Vajrayāna physiology. It is left in Sanskrit because no English equivalent conveys the technical meaning, and the house glossary does not assign it a fixed English rendering.

The phrase ལེག་ཡོ་མ་གྱེ་ལྷ་མོ་, here transliterated and translated as "the goddess Lekgyé Wangmo," is an epithet of a female tantric deity functioning as consort. It likely corresponds to a Sanskrit name such as Sukharājeśvarī or similar; the exact Sanskrit is not established with certainty from the Tibetan alone.

The passage depicts explicitly sexual tantric union between the Blessed One and his consort as the occasion for a doctrinal teaching on the four joys and the subtle-body physiology of the channels and bindus. This is standard inner-tantric content and is not smoothed over in the translation.

- The title given at the chapter colophon, "Jñānasāra" (rendered from རྣམ་ཐོས་ཀྱི་རྒྱུ་ལྷན་པོ་), means "Essence of Gnosis" or "Heart of Gnosis"; I have kept it in transliterated Sanskrit as a title. The full rendering would be "from the glorious Essence of Gnosis."

The fourfold mudrā scheme here reflects a standard Vajrayāna taxonomy: karma mudrā, samaya mudrā, jñāna mudrā, dharma mudrā. The terms "stage of joy," "stage of the sense base," and "stage of the element" are technical sequential stages (corresponding to luminous appearances in tantric contemplative physiology); their exact scholastic correlations depend on the specific tantric system, and the passage is transitional — the Blessed One's answer is cut off at the end of this excerpt.

The opening litany of negations ("It is not secret, not gnosis...") follows the standard via negativa (apophatic) style of tantric absolute descriptions, analogous to Madhyamaka negations but applied to the innate joy. The repeated "not enjoyment" (མཆོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་) appearing twice in close succession is present in the Tibetan and has been retained.

- The terms for the four karmic activities — pacifying through laughter, enriching through

gazing, magnetizing through embrace, wrathful through bringing two into union — follow standard Vajrayāna classifications; their behavioral descriptions here reflect the antinomian yogic register of the text.

The "bird-faced one" and "rope-lady" appear to be technical designations for specific nāḍī or subtle-body channels or their presiding consort-figures, rendered literally as the Tibetan is itself technical and the precise referents are text-specific.

The phrase rendered "the conduct without garments" refers to the observance practice of wearing no clothing, a recognized category of Vajrayāna behavioral yoga.

The colophon title "Jñānasāra" renders the Tibetan dpal ye shes snying po literally as "the Glorious Essence of Gnosis."

- The term rendered "action master" translates las kyi slob dpon, a recognized ritual role distinct from the conferring master; the action master assists in the empowerment ceremony. The phrase "marks" throughout renders mtshan ma, which here refers to the signs or qualifications of spiritual attainment, not the major physical marks of a great being. The "corner of Īśāna" renders dbang ldan gyi mtshams, Īśāna being the lord of the northeast direction. The "sixteen years of age" renders brgya gnyis kyi lo, literally "years of eight-times-two," a standard iconographic description of a deity appearing in the prime of youth at sixteen years old. The size specification "three finger-breadths beyond the thumb, measuring half a cubit and one span" is a literal rendering of a technical ritual measurement formula whose precise practical application may vary by tradition.

- The epithets Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Īśvara, and the Fierce One here designate deity figures in the maṇḍala generated from specific types of bliss in tantric union practice. They are Buddhist tantric emanations using Hindu divine names as epithets, not the Hindu gods as such. The text is from a Mahāyoga or Yoginī-tantra context, consistent with the Śrī Jñānasāra (Glorious Wisdom-Essence) mentioned in the colophon.

The phrase rendered "method of union and merging" translates the Tibetan for the sexual yoga of the tantric path, a standard technical usage in this genre.

The description of the maṇḍala's remaining corner-goddesses is cut off at the end of the supplied passage; the description of the remaining two directions appears to continue beyond what is given here.

- The seed syllable descriptions — "the seventh of the consonant group combined with the fifth of the vowel letter" and "the eighth of the consonant group combined with the sixth of the vowel letter" — are standard tantric cryptographic conventions pointing to specific Sanskrit syllables without spelling them out in plain text. On the traditional Tibetan adaptation of the Sanskrit alphabet, these correspond to the syllables "haṃ" and "hūṃ" respectively, though the exact identification can vary by tradition and commentarial source.

The phrase rendered "clothed in the garments of the directions" refers to the tradition of sky-clad or essentially naked figures, clad only in the ten directions as their garment.

The term rendered "armor-mantra" translates a word literally meaning "armor" or "coat of mail," referring to the protective kavaca-type mantra that guards the practitioner and retinue.

- The epithet "Blessed Lady Supriyā, Queen of Delight" renders the Tibetan name Legs-dgyes-dbang-mo, meaning something like "Sovereign Lady of Excellence and Delight," functioning as a proper name for the female interlocutor established in the preceding context. The phrase "abided in the union of non-duality" renders the technical tantric expression zung-du-med-pa'i sbyor-ba, indicating the state of non-dual union, likely with a tantric valence here beyond mere philosophical non-duality.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.